

Multilingual Health Question Answering in Low-Resource African Languages Challenge

Collaboration with Zindi

Claire Babirye

MAK AI

May 20, 2026

- Motivation
- Objective
- Target End Users
- Dataset Architecture
- Data Distribution
- Conclusion

- Breaking down language barriers to create equitable access to life-saving maternal, sexual and reproductive health information for communities across Africa.

- To develop a multilingual model capable of answering health-related questions on maternal, sexual, and reproductive health in English, Luganda, Kiswahili, Akan and Amharic.

- **Adolescents:** Young people seeking confidential, accurate sexual and reproductive health guidance in their own language.
- **Expectant and new mothers:** Pregnant and lactating mothers needing reliable information about prenatal care, childbirth, and postpartum health.
- **Health workers and NGOs:** Community health counselors and organizations requiring multilingual tools for effective patient engagement.

The task is a sequence-to-sequence multilingual text generation problem, where the model receives a health-related question and must generate an appropriate answer in the same language.

Table: Dataset format in the train and validation sets

ID	input	output	subset
unique ID	question	answer	subset

Table: Dataset format in the test set

ID	input	subset
unique ID	question	subset

Table: Dataset Distribution

Dataset	Size	Description
Train set	29815	Question-Answer pairs for training
Validation set	6686	Question-Answer pairs for validation
Test set	2618	Questions only; answers must be generated

Join us in building AI solutions that save lives and strengthen communities. Together, we can ensure every mother, every adolescent, and every health worker has the knowledge they need, when they need it, in the language they understand.

Thank you for your attention

Claire Babirye
clarybits68@gmail.com